Answers and talk notes

Compare and Order Integers and Rational Numbers

What your student is learning

Tonight we put mixed numbers in order — negatives, fractions and decimals together — using the number line as the judge.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** 0.75. 3 ÷ 4 = 0.75, so 3/4 = 0.75.
2. **A.** −1.5. −1.5 is farther left than −0.5, so −1.5 is less.
3. **C.** −0.25. 1 ÷ 4 = 0.25, and the sign is negative, so −0.25.
4. **D.** −1.2. −1.2 is farthest left, so it is the least.
5. **B.** −2, −0.5, 0.5. From left to right: −2, −0.5, 0.5.
6. **A.** −3/4 < −0.5. −3/4 = −0.75, which is left of −0.5, so −3/4 < −0.5.

Talk about it

Which numbers are negative? After changing to decimals, which is farthest left?

Home mission

Write 0.5, −2 and −0.5 on three scraps of paper. Ask your student to line them up on the table from least to greatest. Which one went farthest left? How do you know?

When they are stuck, ask

- Which of these are to the left of zero?
- Can you sketch a number line and place them?
- Left to right — which comes first?

Try not to say

- −15 is greater than −8 because 15 is greater.
- Ignore the minus signs and order the digits.
- Fractions always come before decimals.